

# DINA KAUR CHAWLA

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**UX Researcher and Strategist** with 3+ years leading qualitative and mixed-methods research for human-centered AI in high-stakes domains including mental health, aviation, and healthcare. Specialized in research synthesis, trust and safety, and translating complex findings into design guidance and system-level recommendations.

## EDUCATION

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|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| <b>MS Human Centered Design and Engineering</b>   University of Washington        | Sep. 2024 – Exp. Jun. 2026 |
| <b>MS Computational Neuroscience, Cognition and AI</b>   University of Nottingham | Sep. 2020 – Dec. 2021      |
| <b>BS Psychology with Cognitive Neuroscience</b>   University of Leicester        | Sep. 2017 – Sep. 2020      |

## EXPERIENCE

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| <b>UX Researcher (Project Lead)</b>   University of Washington, Seattle (WA)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | May. 2025 – Present   |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Led a multi-disciplinary research initiative with <b>17 researchers</b>, exploring AI-enabled mental health support in safety-critical aviation contexts, spanning pilots and industry partners, including Southwest and Delta Airlines.</li><li>Drove mixed-methods analysis of <b>30+ in-depth interviews and 6,000+ survey responses</b>, defined research vision and milestones to deliver data visualizations and system-level insights on trust, stigma, confidentiality, and disclosure risks in regulated environments.</li><li>Translated <b>mixed-methods research</b> into responsible AI design principles that informed system constraints, disclosure boundaries, and usage guardrails for AI-supported mental health tools in aviation contexts.</li></ul> |                       |
| <b>UX Research Intern</b>   Stay You, Seattle (WA)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Jun. 2025 – Sep. 2025 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Defined and executed a usability research, identifying <b>8 critical issues</b>, for an influencer e-commerce site, <a href="https://joeykidney.com">joeykidney.com</a>, evaluating <b>purchase journey</b> for script services through heuristic evaluation and user surveys.</li><li>Shaped product decisions and feature prioritization by translating behavioral analytics, through <b>click paths and heatmaps</b>, into co-designed feature concepts and prototypes with stakeholders.</li><li>Led redesign of site architecture and the <b>end-to-end purchase journey</b> by translating research insights and design requirements into a fully implemented experience aligned with brand positioning and conversion goals.</li></ul>                             |                       |
| <b>UX Researcher</b>   Surecare Calderdale, UK                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Jan. 2023 – Jul. 2024 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Improved customer service experience of <b>60+ caregiver-client matching</b> at a home-care service provider by streamlining handoffs through mixed methods research, reducing reassignment, and escalation in service delivery.</li><li>Increased caregiver and client retention by identifying breakdowns in client-caregiver matching and onboarding journeys through qualitative research, including <b>survey responses and contextual inquiries</b>.</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                       |
| <b>AI Researcher</b>   UntappedAI, UK                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Mar. 2022 – Oct. 2022 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Shaped sentiment analysis and LLM validation at an AI startup focused on mental health and wellbeing by translating UX insights into explicit evaluation criteria for assessing model reliability, interpretability, and confidence thresholds.</li><li>Bridged engineering and clinical teams by translating therapeutic goals and constraints into actionable validation requirements, ensuring AI behavior aligned with user and clinical expectations and informing product decisions.</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                       |

## SPONSORED RESEARCH PROJECTS

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| <b>Reducing Barriers to Social Service Access</b>   Usability Researcher ( <i>Washington 211</i> )                                                                                                                                                                               | Jan. 2025 – Mar. 2025 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Improved accessibility and service discoverability with <b>16</b> users in support-seeking scenarios, translating findings into <b>7</b> design recommendations, <b>5</b> of which were implemented across Washington 211 sites.</li></ul> |                       |
| <b>Simplifying Bioinformatic Workflows</b>   UX Researcher ( <i>Biodepot</i> )                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Jun. 2024 – Sep. 2024 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Researched and redesigned complex bioinformatics workflows for cancer research scientists by triangulating interviews, usability testing, and workflow mapping to improve onboarding and usability across research pipelines.</li></ul>    |                       |

## PUBLICATIONS

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| <b>Understanding Pilots' Perceptions of AI-Mediated Mental Health Support in Aviation</b>   ACM CHI                      | 2026 |
| <a href="#"><u>Digital Copilots: Advancing Pilot Mental Health Through AI Chatbots and Systems</u></a>   AHFE Conference | 2025 |

## SKILLS

**Skills:** Mixed Methods Research, Qualitative Research, Interview Design, Research Synthesis, Thematic Analysis, Usability Testing, Systems-Level UX Research, A/B Testing, Behavior Analytics, Human-Centered AI, Information Architecture, User Flows, Journey Mapping, Prototyping, Interaction Design

**Tools:** Figma, Qualtrics, Hotjar, UserTesting, NVivo, SPSS, Python, Cursor, Lovable